

Recruitment Message

Dear XYZ,

As you know, recent years have seen increased use of cloud services, adoption of hybrid or remote work culture, blurry networks, and more sophisticated attacks. This has resulted in the recommendation of a “never trust, always verify” Zero Trust approach, a strategic cybersecurity model that aims at protecting today’s digital business environments by maintaining constant network security.

In this research study, we are looking for cybersecurity professionals with familiarity and experience in Zero Trust to determine how they perceive and define the Zero Trust concept and what they think are the strengths and weaknesses of the approach in practice. We are also interested in obtaining insights about Zero Trust migration, such as crucial steps toward the Zero Trust journey, capabilities recommended to carry out that journey, and strategies to tackle challenges.

Your expertise and perspective are invaluable to our research. To facilitate this, we are conducting 60-minute interviews, during which we hope to engage in a meaningful discussion about your experiences and insights related to Zero Trust. In appreciation of your time and contributions, we would like to offer you a compensation of \$50 in the form of an Amazon gift card.

By participating in this study, you will play a pivotal role in advancing the collective understanding of Zero Trust within the cybersecurity community, provide directions for further research in the field of Zero Trust, and potentially help guide future directions by regulatory bodies.

Details about the Research Study:

- We estimate that the entire interview will take approximately 60 minutes of your time and can be scheduled at your convenience.
- Our study was approved by [primary researcher’s institution name]’s Institutional Review Board (IRB), and the collected data will only be accessible by our research team.
- Your data will be de-identified, and short quotes from your interview might be used while reporting at most.
- The interview will be conducted through any video calling software convenient to both participants and researchers, such as Zoom.
- All questions will be optional.

Data Anonymization: Only members of the research team will know the participant information and their interviews. Any personal-identifiable information will be anonymized while transcribing and reporting the interview data.

We have attached a consent form that contains more details regarding this research study, as required by [primary researcher’s institution name]’s IRB.

To confirm your participation, please reply to this email. We will then proceed with the study protocol and request you to fill the demographic survey before moving forward with the interview session.

Please let me know if there are any further questions on this study. I am looking forward to hearing from you. Thank you for your time and help!